Idea generation techniques

Level 5 · Thinking tools · Answers

Answers and marking guidance

Award one mark per correct, developed point unless stated. Other valid answers should be credited.

2 Explain how biomimicry could inspire ideas.

- Biomimicry: copying how nature solves problems
- Example linked to the brief, e.g. a cactus collecting water, or a flower that opens to show how much you've drunk

3 Quick check

- a) Biomimicry
- b) No judging
- c) Crazy 8s
- d) Eliminate

4 Key terms

- 1 – C
- 2 – F
- 3 – B
- 4 – E
- 5 – A
- 6 – D

5 Describe how you would run a "worst possible idea" session.

- Ask everyone for terrible ideas for the library (no judging)
- Write them all down quickly
- Flip each into its opposite to find good ideas, e.g. "no seats" → "lots of different kinds of seating"

6 Explain what is meant by ‘Lateral thinking’.

- Approaching a problem from unexpected angles

7 Explain what is meant by ‘Biomimicry’.

- Solving problems by copying ideas from nature